

6.2 PRE MODERATION MONITORING OF COURSEWORK TASKS

Centres should devise their own tasks. It is not necessary to submit these tasks to OCR for approval.

The three **Integrated Coursework** activities (Part A) – **performing, composing and appraising** - and the **Further Coursework** (Part B) can be carried out and assessed at any time during the course. **Performances** must be recorded. **Composing** should be presented in written and/or recorded format. Both compositions must have a clearly defined brief: in the case of Composition 1 (Part A) this will form part of the appraisal process; in Composition 2 (Part B) the brief must be articulated on the Candidate's Intentions Form which will be provided by OCR. **Appraising** can be in written or recorded format and must be an integral part of the process.

Performing (Individual part or piece)

Accompaniments

In an accompanied solo performance, the candidate should have a main or leading part. There can be any number of accompanists, who need not be GCSE candidates. Performing with a pre-recorded backing is acceptable provided that the candidate's part is not consistently doubled and is clearly distinguishable. Performing with a recording **and** doubling the lead line is not acceptable. In cases where the accompaniment consistently doubles the leading line unnecessarily, it may be necessary for the accompanying part(s) to be adapted in order to suit the requirements of the examination.

Use of ICT

Where a candidate musically enhances their live performance of a solo part or piece using technology, credit can be given for that enhancement. Musical enhancement can come in one of three ways:

- effects added during or after the recording of the performance of the piece;
- use of multi-tracking;
- use of a computer/midi/sequencing package.

Centres must take into account the following points when supervising performing activities which involve the use of technology:

- the part to be initially assessed must be performed live;
- full details of the technology used must be provided using the **Use of Technology Form** (which will be provided by OCR).
- the enhancement process must be clearly documented and authenticated by the teacher;
- the candidate must be solely responsible for the enhancement;
- where the outcome differs significantly from the initial live input or where the live input is difficult to identify aurally, a recording of both will be required for assessment.

Performing (Ensemble)

An ensemble must involve the candidate in performing with at least **one other person, live**. Multi-tracked performances (including performance with a backing track) and the use of pre-programmed tracks or automatic accompaniments are acceptable as parts in an ensemble but could inhibit the demonstration of a high level of ensemble skills as these accompaniments could limit the candidate's opportunity to respond. The candidate's part should not be consistently doubled, though it is acceptable that parts come together occasionally.

In cases where the candidate's part may be difficult to identify on the recording, a copy of the music must be sent to the moderator.

Composing

Compositions may be submitted in recorded and/or written form. Where both a written and a recorded version are submitted the assessor should indicate which version represents the true intentions of the candidate.

It is helpful to candidates if their compositions are recorded. It is not necessary for candidates to perform their work - it can be performed by a teacher or other pupils (whether candidates or not) but the performance should not enhance the candidate's work beyond their intention. When the candidate's intention is only implied and the performer(s) are expected to interpret the composition (e.g. by improvising in a section, or by adding accompanimental figures to a chord sequence) credit cannot be given for this.

All compositions which are not in conventional staff notation must be recorded. When such recordings involve others, the performance should take place under the direct supervision of the candidate. The assessor must make clear which aspects of the recording can be identified as attributable directly to the candidate. If other performers are required to interpret graphic symbols and the candidate has not made clear exactly what they mean, credit cannot be given to the candidate for such interpretation.

Arrangements: To be worthy of credit, arrangements must include some creative input. A copy of the initial stimulus (written or recorded) must be submitted with the candidate's work. Transposition and transcription skills cannot be credited.

Joint Compositions: If joint compositions are submitted, only the identifiable input of the candidate can be credited (e.g. a particular section or a melodic line to which others have added harmony and rhythm parts). Joint compositions are not appropriate to the requirements of **Integrated Coursework** (Composition 1) and should not be submitted here. Joint decisions cannot be credited to any one candidate. It must be stressed that joint composition work can disadvantage candidates, and Centres should, therefore, avoid submitting such work if at all possible.

Brief: All compositions must have a clearly defined brief. The brief for Composition 1 is integral to the coursework and is assessed. For Composition 2 the brief should be based on the knowledge and understanding developed in Area of Study 3 or 4. If the brief does not relate to an appropriate Area of Study marks cannot be awarded. If the composition moves significantly away from the Area of Study during the composition process, this will be reflected in the final mark awarded. The brief should be stated on the **Candidate's Intentions Form**. Changes to the brief during the process are acceptable within the confines of the parameters defined by the Areas of Study. For instance, if the candidate sets out to write a *Waltz* for keyboard and changes it to a *Waltz* for trumpet and drum, this change would be acceptable since the *Waltz* aspect (i.e. the link with Area of Study 3) is unchanged. However, if the candidate changes it to a *March* for keyboard, this would not be acceptable as it would have moved away from the content of Area of Study 3. In the latter case, no marks would be available for the extent to which the composition meets the brief.